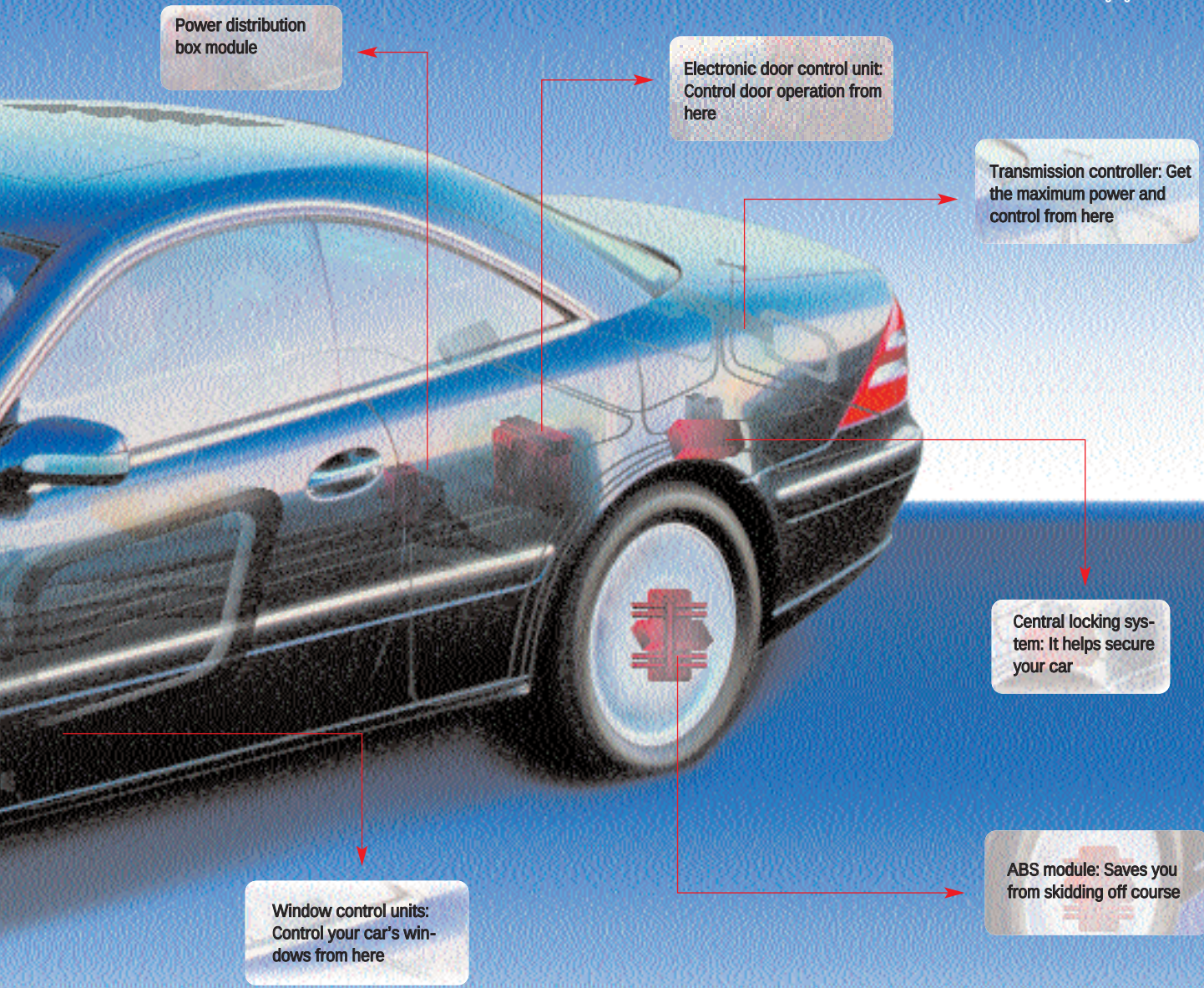




THE ROAD

controlling various functions in a car. They are now used to control factors such as emission, power, fuel consumption, safety, communication, security, and navigation. (See box, 'A Mind of its own', to get a better perspective of the different types of 'car computers'). Consider the Mitsubishi Lancer. A head turner, this hunk of a car has an intelligence to match. The Lancer has several computers, one of the main ones being the one that controls MPFI (Multi Point Fuel Injection).

You can also check the car's health using the instrument panel on the dashboard—computers again. The Lancer also makes use of computers to handle goodies such as power windows, remote door mirrors, fuel and boot lid controls, central locking, and so on.

Computers@engine.car

The Electronic Control Unit (ECU) controlling the engine is usually the most powerful computer.

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